2026 - 2029

Strategic Plan on a Page

Mission

We empower Austinites to shape a more inclusive, resilient, and meaningful community culture through preservation.

Vision

A future where historic places play a meaningful role in everyone's life, inspiring all Austinites to become advocates for preservation.

PRESERVATION AUSTIN

Sustain What We've Built

Make the gains of the last few years endure through stable funding, a strong team, and a well-kept McFarland-McBee House.

Financial Resilience

Grow and diversify annual revenue streams so we never depend on any single source.

Measure: *Months of operating reserve; number of income streams; House upkeep fully funded each year.*

Mission Momentum

Hold every program, event, and touchpoint to a high standard of value and impact.

Measure: *Program goals met or exceeded; membership growth; influence gained (seats at the table, decisions shaped, positions cited).*

Operational Excellence

Set the bar for how a preservation organization should run. Stay efficient, stay curious, and keep raising our own standard.

Measure: *Cost-to-output ratio; number of new approaches adopted; year-over-year growth in capacity and reach.*

Be a Household Name

Grow PA's reach and reputation so that when Austinites think about protecting their city's character, they think of us first.

Tell a Clear, Consistent Story

Reach more Austinites with one strategic narrative about why preservation matters and why PA matters.

Measure: *Membership growth; follower count; rate at which followers convert to members; mission awareness.*

Grow Advocacy on Every Front

Turn awareness into action across community, political, and business arenas, wherever preservation decisions get made.

Measure: *Advocates activated by arena; policy and business wins influenced; members and donors gained.*

Open the Door to Participation

Create easy, visible ways for any Austinites to take part.

Measure: *Number of entry-point activities; first-time participants; reach across all parts of the city.*

Embed Equity Everywhere

Make equity the source of our strength. It shapes who we serve, how we lead, how we work, and elevates the story we help tell.

Hold Ourselves to a Clear Equity Standard

Define what equity means for PA and commit to it with real rigor in how we operate.

Measure: *Written standard adopted; commitments tracked and reported on each year.*

Build Pipeline of Future Preservationists

Open preservation to young people from every part of Austin, building a generation of members, advocates and leaders as diverse as the city itself.

Measure: *People > 22 years engaged; participant diversity; lasting relationships that move into deeper roles over time.*

Preserve the Whole Story of Austin

Draw on diverse voices to protect the places and histories that have been overlooked, so PA becomes the organization that tells Austin's complete story.

Measure: *Underrepresented sites and histories preserved; community partners co-leading projects; diverse representation in decision-making roles in and outside of PA*

2026 - 2029

Our Values

Mission

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Vision

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PRESERVATION AUSTIN

How We Work

These are guiding principles and fundamental beliefs that define how we desire to work. Values create cohesion across the organization by establishing shared mindsets, behaviors, and expectations that allow everyone to do their best work.

Accountable

We do what is right, not what makes us right. We keep the best interests of those we serve top of mind, and we measure our impact against the highest standards of integrity, equity, and fiscal responsibility.

Inclusive

We build a culture that encourages, supports, and celebrates the diverse voices of our organization and our city. Diversity and inclusion fuel our creativity, break down barriers, and bring us closer to the people we serve.

Locally Focused

We have Austin's best interest at heart every day. Preserving Austin's individuality lets our citizens thrive, invites visitors to connect, and makes our city a model of preservation in action.

Collaborating Enthusiastically

We do our best work when we come together to solve the toughest challenges facing our city. We value those who speak thoughtfully, respect diversity of opinion, and listen carefully with an open mind.

Taking the Long View

We leverage our resources for the greatest possible impact and hold ourselves accountable to future generations, saving places that matter, that stand the test of time, and that honor a holistic view of Austin's heritage.

Thinking Big

We never settle. We have the courage and curiosity to challenge the status quo and find new ways for preservation to make a positive difference in our community.